The Tide Festival

Tier	Tier 2
Party Level	**4 PCs at Level 6** — Naan (Lilli), Nalith (Piper), Kto (Kaitlyn), Yinu (Sev)
Duration	~2 hours
Setting	**New Sarshel**, Impiltur — the salt road east of the dark Sarshel Light, the Landward Gate, and the city's Tide Festival. Canon: *FR Campaign Guide* p. 145; *Player's Guide* p. 107
Hook From	**End of Session 007** — the lighthouse is dark, Veyra's ledger is in the party's hands, and the *Embergull* survivors need an escort nine miles east
Tone	Happy, silly, heroic. Every villain is a goof who gives up; nobody dies



Adventure Summary

The heroes who put out the lighthouse walk into **New Sarshel** on the first day of its yearly **Tide Festival** †, and the whole city cheers them through the gate. Veyra's ledger, which looked so sinister in the lantern room, turns out to be a comedy. The people who paid her are the **Gilded Gull Club** †: three vain nobles whose seaside mansions now stand a mile from the water. Veyra sold them "**the Summoning**" — and they thought she meant *summoning the sea back to their doorsteps*. They were fooled, not wicked, and they had no idea about the prisoners.

The session is a day at the fair with a mystery running through it. The party fends off a fake toll booth on the road, gets a heroes' welcome, then spends festival day at the temple bells and the games while working out who the Gulls are and why they paid. At sunset, the club's leader panics and reads a leftover Veyra scroll from the club's parade float. The giant clockwork sea serpent comes alive and charges down the parade route. The party stops it, rescues the crowd, and ends the night under fireworks with rewards, a new job for Tamsin, and a ship ready to take them anywhere on the Sea of Fallen Stars.

Canon used: New Sarshel is the one Impilturan port that kept pace with the retreating Sea of Fallen Stars and won the region's trade; people from shrinking towns have moved there (*CG* p. 145, *PG* p. 107). **Everything else** — the festival, the Gull Club, the Bracks, the float, Tibbet, the Hall of Many Lights, the freed prisoners' names — is a **DM addition** †.

Tone Rules — for every scene

- **Villains are silly, not scary.** The Brack Brothers and the Gilded Gulls surrender, apologise, blab, or run away comically. Nobody is killed, and nobody needs to be.
- **Hazards are slapstick.** Confetti, pickle barrels, water jets, flattened stalls. When something goes wrong for a bystander, they end up soggy, sticky, or sitting in a fountain — never hurt.
- **Every PC gets a win.** Each scene names a spotlight for a specific PC. Fiorn is not here (Fox has moved to his own game) — do not write him in.
- **The light lied; the festival gives back.** In Session 007 the beam showed each PC a false version of their heart's desire. Today each PC can get a small, *true* piece of it (see Scenes 1.2, 2.1, and 2.2). These are offers, not requirements.
- **No dark turns.** No kidnapping, ritual, or demon plot this session. Veyra's deeper ties stay an untouched mystery (see *Threads Left Open*).

The Day's Shape

When	Where	Scene	What happens
Early morning	The salt road, ~6 miles east of the tower	**1.1**	The walk east; the Brack Brothers' fake toll booth (**Encounter 1**, optional)
Late morning	The Landward Gate	**1.2**	Heroes' welcome on **Lantern Eve**, the festival's opening day; beds, supper, harbor lanterns at dusk; **long rest overnight**
Noon, Tide Day	The Hall of Many Lights	**2.1**	The Noon Bells; blessings; a priest reads the ledger
Afternoon	Festival Green	**2.2**	Games; find the Gulls and learn why they paid
Sunset	Harbor Way parade route	**3.1**	The Grand Parade; the float comes alive (**Encounter 2**)
Nightfall	Harbor plaza	**3.2**	Fireworks, apologies, rewards, a ship's offer

Rest. The party has not rested since Session 006 (the DM confirmed it at the start of Session 007). A **short rest** is available on the road before the toll booth (the survivors stop for breakfast). The **long rest** comes on Lantern Eve night in the beds Warden Plumm finds them, so the party starts Tide Day fully rested for the parade.

What's Really Going On (DM only)

- **The Gilded Gull Club** is three nobles from **Gull Row**, the old waterfront street of New Sarshel's first harbor. The sea kept retreating and the city built new docks to follow it — and Gull Row was left a mile inland, its piers standing over dry sand. The club wants its sea views back.
- **Veyra** found them a season ago and sold them "the Summoning": pay for her work at the old Sarshel Light and the tide will come home. They paid 400 gp apiece. They never went to the lighthouse and never asked questions. **They did not know about the prisoners or the demon.**
- **The ledger** lists their three names with the payments, each marked *"for the Summoning."* (At the table in Session 007 the party read it as payment to summon the demon — which is what Veyra meant. Both readings are true; that is the joke.)
- **Last night**, Gullwhistle's footman watched the lighthouse from Gull Row with a spyglass and saw the light go out. Gullwhistle panicked about his name being in whatever papers Veyra kept, and hired the **Brack Brothers** to stop anyone coming from the lighthouse and "collect" any books or papers as a "toll."
- **Veyra also gave the club a souvenir**: a *Scroll of the Rising Tide* †, "to be read when the sea returns." It is really a scroll that animates objects. Gullwhistle has it in his coat.

Act I — The Road In

Act I, Scene 1.1 — The Salt Road Parade

Purpose / transition: Pick up exactly where Session 007 ended, introduce the survivors as fun company, and give the table a silly, skippable fight that points straight at the city. The Bracks' blabbing hands over the first clue: *a fancy gent with a golden gull pin*.

Setting

- **Location:** The pale coast road across the dry seabed, from the dark Sarshel Light east toward New Sarshel. Session 007 cut as the column set out from the tower; the sun comes up on the road. The toll booth stands about six miles along, in the early morning.
- **See:** A white, cracked salt flat glittering in the sunrise; stranded old ships far off on the salt; behind the party, the lighthouse standing dark at last; ahead, the towers of a city on the horizon. Then, in the middle of the road: an old abandoned salt-collector's hut the Bracks moved into overnight, a striped gate pole across the road, and a hand-painted sign that reads **TOLL** (spelled wrong — "TOAL").
- **Hear:** Bram's sea shanties, the donkey's complaints, the creak of Dagna's pickle wagon, gulls. At the booth: someone shushing someone else very loudly.
- **Smell:** Salt, dust, dill pickles, breakfast smoke.
- **Sense: Insight DC 10** (or just watching them) — the "toll collectors" have never collected a toll in their lives. **Perception DC 12** — a big man is hiding badly behind the salt barrels, and something in the washtub is wearing a hat.

NPCs

The walkers (survivors and freed prisoners)

- **Disposition going in:** Grateful, chatty, and in awe of the party. Roughly fifteen people: **Oren** and the *Embergull* camp (ordinary folk with packs), **Tamsin Reed**, and the four freed prisoners, named here for the first time †:
- **Motivations:** Get to the city safely; thank the heroes; enter Dagna's pickles in the contest.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** If the party is kind to them on the road, they spread the story everywhere. **Wren runs ahead** from the toll booth to tell the city (she is fast and cannot keep a secret), which is why the gate cheers in 1.2. If **Sev says Yinu never grabbed her staff and pack in the lantern room**, Tamsin hands them over now — she brought them down.

The Brack Brothers †

- **Disposition going in:** Nervous bravado. **Mort** (skinny, crooked top hat, does the talking), **Ned** (short, worried, holds the toll bucket), and **Little Ollie** (enormous, gentle, apologises when he hits anyone), plus **Sir Pinchington**, Ollie's pet giant crab, who wears a tiny hat.
- **Motivations:** Earn the fat purse a "fancy gent" paid them last night. Their orders: *stop anyone coming from the lighthouse; the toll is one book or bundle of papers each.* They are hopeless at it.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:**

Encounter: Encounter 1 — The Brack Brothers' Toll Booth (File 2). Optional; Medium.

Conditional follow-through:

If the Bracks were befriended, paid, or let go: they turn up at the Grand Parade in 3.1 (Warden Plumm hires them as stewards) and clear one crowd group from the float's path on round 2.

If the Bracks were beaten: the walkers tie them up and hand them to the watch at the gate in 1.2; by Tide Day they are in the stocks on Festival Green in 2.2, cheerfully selling "TOAL" souvenirs; they will repeat the golden-pin clue to anyone who buys one.

Either way: the party knows **"golden bird pin, big feathery hat."** That is the thread to Scene 2.2.

Act I, Scene 1.2 — Heroes at the Gate

Purpose / transition: Pay off the party's good deed with a big, warm welcome, house the survivors, explain the festival, and give everyone the long rest they badly need. The festival schedule becomes the session's map.

Setting

- **Location:** The **Landward Gate** of New Sarshel and the streets just inside. It is **Lantern Eve**, the festival's opening day.
- **See:** A crowd at the gate (Wren in front, jumping up and down); strings of bunting; paper lanterns going up on every balcony; workers hammering stalls on Festival Green; down at the harbor, the new docks crowded with ships. On the far side of the city, the long empty piers of **Gull Row** stand over dry sand.
- **Hear:** Cheering, a brass band warming up badly, a town crier announcing tomorrow's schedule, a fiddle somewhere.
- **Smell:** Fried dough, roasting nuts, sea wind from the new harbor.
- **Sense: History DC 12** or asking anyone — the Tide Festival celebrates the year New Sarshel "caught the sea": when the water drew back, the city built new docks to follow it, and it has prospered ever since.

NPCs

Warden Bettina Plumm †

- **Disposition going in:** Thrilled. A brisk halfling festival warden with an enormous clipboard and a whistle.
- **Motivations:** Run a perfect festival. Now she has *real heroes* for it.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** Finds beds for every survivor and the party at **the Salty Pelican** inn, free. Hands the party the festival schedule (*Handout — The Tide Festival Schedule*, File 3) and invites them to ride at the front of tomorrow's Grand Parade. If shown the ledger now, she frowns: "Gullwhistle? *Lord* Gullwhistle? From Gull Row?" — but she has a festival to run and asks the party to bring proof, not gossip, ideally before the parade. She will point the three Gulls out to the party at the games tomorrow. **She is the person who can make the Gulls pay restitution in 3.2.**

Tamsin Reed

- **Disposition going in:** Warm, tired, glad to be free. She has kept a light for twenty years and does not know what to do with her hands.
- **Motivations:** Make sure the survivors are housed; find a use for herself.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** Mentions the harbor's own light is badly kept ("a candle in a jar, that one"). Sets up her new job in 3.2.

Encounter: None

Lantern Eve, at dusk (optional, gentle). Everyone floats a paper lantern on the harbor for someone they miss or something they hope for. **Nalith's spotlight:** in Session 007 the light showed her Christmas with her late mother; here she can float a lantern for her mother. Keep it short and sweet, and only if Piper wants it.

Conditional follow-through:

If the party showed Warden Plumm the ledger: in 2.2 she finds them on Festival Green and points out the three Gulls by name — no searching needed.

If the party mentioned the golden-bird-pin clue to anyone in the city: they hear that "the Gilded Gull Club wears gold gull pins — those Gull Row snobs."

Long rest overnight at the Salty Pelican. The party starts Tide Day fully restored.

Act II — The Festival

Act II, Scene 2.1 — Bells and Blessings

Purpose / transition: A warm, quiet scene before the noise. The church thread from Session 007 pays off, each PC can get a gentle blessing, and a priest reads the ledger closely enough to name the club and the strange phrase *"for the Summoning."* That sends the party to the games to find the Gulls.

Setting

- **Location: The Hall of Many Lights** † — New Sarshel's big, friendly temple, with an altar for every god anyone in the city has ever prayed to, and one small unmarked altar *"for the gods we haven't met yet."*
- **See:** Hundreds of candles; stained glass with every color of sea; families in festival clothes; a children's choir lined up and fidgeting.
- **Hear:** The **Noon Bells** — every bell in the city at once — then the choir.
- **Smell:** Beeswax, incense, flowers, festival bread blessed at the door.
- **Sense: Religion DC 10** — the unmarked altar welcomes any god, including ones no priest in the Hall knows by name (useful for Kto's god, Naan's patron Zophiel, or anyone else's).

NPCs

Brother Amsel Tidewell †

- **Disposition going in:** Kind, curious, and a bit nosy. A round, cheerful priest who keeps the unmarked altar.
- **Motivations:** Welcome every visitor; thank the heroes; see a good mystery solved.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:**

Encounter: None

Conditional follow-through:

If the party asked Amsel about Veyra's demon: he says, gently, that it is over, the four prisoners are safe, and the Hall will look after them — he will not let it turn into a dark story today.

If the party skips the Hall: Brother Amsel finds them on Festival Green in 2.2 handing out blessed bread, and reads the ledger there.

Either way: the party knows **the Gilded Gull Club**, **Gull Row**, and the phrase **"for the Summoning."**

Act II, Scene 2.2 — Festival Games and the Gilded Gulls

Purpose / transition: The fun centre of the session. Every PC gets a game to win while the party works out who the Gulls are and *why* they paid. What the party learns and who they befriend here changes the Grand Parade.

Setting

- **Location: Festival Green**, a big lawn by the old seawall, packed with stalls and games, with Gull Row's stranded piers in plain view.
- **See:** An archery range with straw gulls as targets; a sand track for crab races; a pickle-eating stage (Dagna's barrels on it); Tibbet's fireworks cart in a roped-off corner; and the three **Gilded Gulls** in absurd seabird finery and golden gull pins, holding court under a striped awning. Beyond it all, the club's parade float: a giant painted **clockwork sea serpent** being polished for tonight.

- **Hear:** Barkers, cheering, a crab announcer, Bram singing, and Lord Gullwhistle's loud laugh.
- **Smell:** Dill, sugar, fried fish, gunpowder near Tibbet's cart.
- **Sense: Detect Magic** — faint transmutation from a scroll in Gullwhistle's coat. **Arcana DC 13** on the float — it is full of clockwork, but there is nothing magic about it (yet).

The games (pick any; each is a quick roll or two)

- **Kto — the Archery Contest.** Three rounds against the city's best. Ranged attack rolls against AC 15, 17, 19; win two of three to take the Champion's Sash. Kto's +9 longbow is made for this.
- **Nalith — the Crab Races.** Pick a crab (Animal Handling DC 12 to choose a fast one; a druid may simply *ask* the crabs). Win and the crab, **Admiral Snips**, decides it lives with Nalith now.
- **Yinu — Tibbet's Fireworks.** Tibbet's finale rockets are mixed up. Arcana DC 13 (or any clever plan) sorts them. Tibbet teaches Yinu a fireworks trick — **the real lesson the light faked with Elminster** — and gives her a scroll (see *Loot*).
- **Everyone — the Pickle-Eating Contest.** Constitution saves, DC 10, then 12, then 14; last one standing wins Dagna's Golden Gherkin. **No pickled eggs** — a certain hero's religion forbids them.

NPCs

Lord Percival Gullwhistle †

- **Disposition going in:** Jolly, loud, and secretly terrified. Plump, ginger moustache, monocle, feathered tricorn hat with a golden gull, gold gull pin. He recognises the party as "the lighthouse heroes" and sweats.
- **Motivations:** Get the sea back to his doorstep; never be embarrassed in public; get that ledger.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** He tries to buy the ledger ("for my collection — 50 gold? 100?"). **Insight DC 12** — he is scared, not dangerous. He will not confess on his own; he blusters that the sea "will come home tonight, you'll see." He has Veyra's scroll in his coat (**Sleight of Hand DC 15** to lift it — if the party gets it, see *Conditional follow-through*).

Lady Marisol Brightwater †

- **Disposition going in:** Polite, a little sad. She misses swimming off her own pier.
- **Motivations:** The sea back; to not be a bad person.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** The weak link. **Persuasion DC 12**, a kind word, or ***Charm Person*** (which works fine out of combat) gets the whole story: Veyra promised to "summon the tide home"; they paid 400 gp each; they never went to the lighthouse. Told about the prisoners, she is horrified and **switches sides**. She knows the float's secret: **the big brass wind-key on its back turns it off.**

Sir Dunstan Pellow †

- **Disposition going in:** Blustering; waves a cane.
- **Motivations:** Sail his yacht from his front door again; never admit a mistake.
- **Possible outcomes and effects: Insight DC 10** — he is just embarrassed. **Intimidation DC 12** — he blurts *"It was Percival's idea!"* within earshot of the crowd.

Tibbet Sparkwright †

- **Disposition going in:** Delighted by anyone who likes explosions.
- **Motivations:** A perfect finale.

- **Possible outcomes and effects:** Overheard Gullwhistle bragging: *"Tonight, at the parade, I read the Tide Scroll and the sea comes home!"* Gives the clue to anyone who helps with her rockets.

Hettie Quillfeather

- **Disposition going in:** Eager to show off her map.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** Her map shows Gull Row a mile inland and the Gull Club's piers over dry sand — **the "why"** in one picture.

Exposing the club. The party **exposes** the Gulls if they make the story public with proof: show the ledger and Marisol's confession (or Dunstan's blurt, or Hettie's map plus the ledger) to Warden Plumm, or to the crowd from the pickle stage. There is no wrong way to do it.

Encounter: None

Conditional follow-through:

If the party exposed the club: Gullwhistle, cornered and red-faced, climbs onto the float at the parade to "prove the sea is coming" and reads the scroll in front of everyone. **3.1 happens.**

Otherwise: Gullwhistle reads the scroll as the club's grand finale at the parade, exactly as Tibbet overheard. **3.1 happens either way.**

If Marisol switched sides: in 3.1 she shouts the wind-key secret on round 1, and climbing onto the float is automatic for the first PC who tries.

If the party lifted the scroll from Gullwhistle: he reads a *second* copy (Veyra sold him two — of course she did). The float still wakes, but Gullwhistle is not riding it — he is in the grandstand, waving his arms.

Spotlight wins carry forward: Kto's sash, Admiral Snips, Tibbet's scroll, and the Golden Gherkin all appear in 3.2.

Act III — The Grand Parade

Act III, Scene 3.1 — The Runaway Float

Purpose / transition: The big, funny set-piece fight. The float wakes, the party saves the crowd and stops it, and the Gulls' scheme falls apart in front of the whole city — in a fountain.

Setting

- **Location: Harbor Way**, the parade route, from the top of the street down to the harbor plaza and its big fountain. The party is at the front of the parade (Warden Plumm insisted).
- **See:** Cheering crowds in the grandstands; a pickle stall; a puppet show for little kids by the fountain; confetti cannons on the corners; the **Grand Sea-Serpent Float**, teal and gold, with Gullwhistle standing on it holding up a scroll.
- **Hear:** A brass band, cheering, then Gullwhistle's voice: *"RISE, O SEA!"* — then a very large creak.
- **Smell:** Gunpowder, sugar, sea air, and soon, a great deal of pickle brine.
- **Sense: Arcana DC 12** once it wakes — the scroll animated the float; it isn't the sea, a demon, or anything dangerous beyond being a runaway parade float the size of a house. ***Dispel Magic*** can end it (File 2).

NPCs

Lord Percival Gullwhistle

- **Disposition going in:** Proud for exactly one second, then terrified. Clinging to the float's back and shouting for help — unless the party lifted his scroll in 2.2, in which case he is in the grandstand waving his arms.
- **Motivations:** Not fall off. Not be laughed at. (Too late for the second one.)
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** Takes no actions in the fight. Any PC who climbs aboard can pluck him off as part of their move, and he is grateful forever. If he is still aboard when the float stops, he lands in the fountain with it.

Encounter: Encounter 2 — The Grand Sea-Serpent Float (File 2). Hard.

Conditional follow-through:

If the Bracks were befriended in 1.1: they show up as parade stewards and clear one crowd group on round 2.

If Marisol switched sides in 2.2: she shouts the wind-key secret on round 1.

However the float stops (smashed, dispelled, or wound down), it ends in the fountain with a sad whistle — and **Gullwhistle, if he was aboard, lands in the fountain with it.** Soaked and humbled, he confesses everything to the crowd in 3.2 whether or not the club was exposed earlier.

Crowd groups saved (0–3) carry into 3.2's cheers and rewards.

Act III, Scene 3.2 — Fireworks and Rewards

Purpose / transition: The happy ending. The Gulls apologise and make it right, everyone gets rewarded, Tamsin gets a new light, and a ship offers to take the party anywhere — the hook for the next session.

Setting

- **Location:** The harbor plaza, around the fountain, at nightfall.
- **See:** The float in pieces in the fountain; the crowd pressing in; Tibbet's finale rockets lighting the sky over the new harbor; ships' lanterns on the water.
- **Hear:** The biggest cheer of the day, Bram leading the whole plaza in a shanty, fireworks.
- **Smell:** Gunpowder, wet canvas, pickle brine, sea.

NPCs

Lord Gullwhistle and the Gilded Gull Club

- **Disposition going in:** Soggy, ashamed, relieved.
- **Motivations:** To stop being laughed at.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** Gullwhistle apologises to the crowd; Marisol (and grudgingly Dunstan) too. Warden Plumm orders **restitution**: the club pays for **new homes in the city for every *Embergull* survivor and freed prisoner**, pays to restore the harbor light, and pays the party a **reward of 600 gp**. **If the party exposed the club in 2.2,** the club also hosts a free feast for the whole festival tomorrow, and Gullwhistle gives the party his ridiculous feathered hat as a trophy.

Warden Bettina Plumm

- **Disposition going in:** Overjoyed.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** Names the party **Heroes of the Tide** in front of the whole city. For each crowd group saved in 3.1, the crowd gives a bigger cheer; **if all three were saved, every PC gains Heroic Inspiration.**

She names **Tamsin Reed keeper of the harbor light**, and Tamsin, for the first time all session, looks like she knows exactly what to do with her hands.

Captain Ama Lorrow †

- **Disposition going in:** Impressed and grinning. A cheerful half-orc sea captain of the merchant ship ***Laughing Otter***.
- **Motivations:** Good company on a long voyage, and heroes are good luck.
- **Possible outcomes and effects:** Offers the party **free passage anywhere on the Sea of Fallen Stars**, sailing in three days. **This is the hook for Session 009:** ask the players where they want to go.

Encounter: None

Conditional follow-through:

The *Embergull* survivors and the four freed prisoners settle in New Sarshel: Dagna's pickles win a stall, Hettie gets a job at the harbor office, Bram sings at the Salty Pelican, and Wren starts an apprenticeship at a city bakery (and keeps the party's autographs).

Tamsin keeps the harbor light — a friend in New Sarshel if the party ever comes back.

The ledger goes to Warden Plumm as evidence, unless the party wants to keep it.

Session 009: wherever the *Laughing Otter* sails.

Threads Left Open — Do Not Resolve Today

- **Who Veyra really worked for, and why she wanted a demon.** The Gulls only paid her; they know nothing more. Leave it alone.
- **Sela's fate, and Oberon** (Session 006).
- **The drow beneath Old Skull and Shadowdale unwarned** (Session 006) — Brother Amsel's letter is the only nudge, and only if the party wants it.
- **Yinu's cipher book** and **Naan's Lathander letter** — untouched.
- **Fiorn** — Fox has moved to his own game; nothing in the fiction explains where Fiorn is. Do not write him in.
- **Tyvlex (Kaila) and Dirk (Ari)** — not at this table.

Loot & Rewards Summary

Reward	From	When
25 gp	The Bracks' purse (the fancy gent's money)	1.1 — if they surrender or are befriended
600 gp (150 gp each)	Gilded Gull Club restitution	3.2
Champion's Sash (cosmetic) and **3 × +1 arrows**	Archery Contest	2.2 — Kto, if she wins
Admiral Snips — a crab pet (no stats; very loyal)	Crab Races	2.2 — Nalith, if she wins
Spell scroll of *Pyrotechnics* (*Xanathar's Guide*; Yinu can copy it)	Tibbet Sparkwright	2.2 — Yinu, or whoever helped
Golden Gherkin (cosmetic trophy)	Dagna	2.2 — pickle champion
2 × potion of healing	The Hall of Many Lights	2.1
Gullwhistle's feathered hat (trophy)	The Gull Club	3.2 — if the club was exposed early
Heroic Inspiration for every PC	The crowd	3.2 — if all three crowd groups were saved
Free passage on the *Laughing Otter*	Captain Ama Lorrow	3.2

Leveling: sheets should already be rebuilt to Level 6 before play (the milestone was earned in Session 004). No new milestone is required by this session; that is the DM's call.

DM Additions †

The Tide Festival, Lantern Eve and Tide Day; the Gilded Gull Club (Gullwhistle, Brightwater, Pellow) and Gull Row; the Brack Brothers and Sir Pinchington; Warden Bettina Plumm; the Salty Pelican; the Hall of Many Lights and Brother Amsel Tidewell; Tibbet Sparkwright; the four freed prisoners' names (Bram Tolliver, Hettie Quillfeather, Dagna Stoutbarrel, Wren Ashby); Captain Ama Lorrow and the *Laughing Otter*; the *Scroll of the Rising Tide*; the Grand Sea-Serpent Float; all stat blocks in File 2.

Combat Tracker — The Tide Festival

Two silly fights. Encounter 1 is **optional** — the Brack Brothers can be paid, tricked, or talked past — and they give up fast. Encounter 2 is the session's big set piece: a runaway parade float with a crowd to save and three ways to stop it. **Nobody dies in either fight** (see the non-lethal rule in each).

Party: four PCs at Level 6. 2014 DMG per-PC thresholds — **Easy 300 · Medium 600 · Hard 900 · Deadly 1,400** — so at **4 PCs**: **Easy 1,200 · Medium 2,400 · Hard 3,600 · Deadly 5,600.** Every stat block is † **homebrew** except Sir Pinchington (a *Monster Manual* giant crab in a hat); CRs are provisional budget ratings — run them loosely and for laughs.

> ***Tactical maps are generated.*** *The written distances and terrain below remain authoritative if the artwork differs. Exact prompts are in* `images/images.json`.

Encounter 1 — The Brack Brothers' Toll Booth

Act I, Scene 1.1 · Optional · Medium (1,375 XP × 2 = 2,750 adjusted / Medium 2,400 – Hard 3,600 at 4×L6)

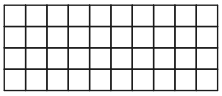
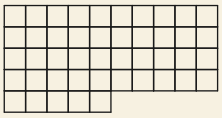
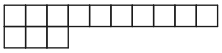
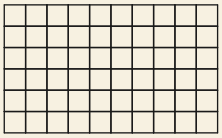
Summary

Location	The salt road, about six miles east of the Sarshel Light, two hours after sunrise. A rickety toll hut, a striped gate pole, salt barrels, an upturned rowboat, a broken mast with a rope swing, and a washtub.
Light	Bright morning sun.
Terrain	Flat salt flat; a 15-ft road; a patch of **wet salt mud** (difficult terrain); props anyone can use (see *Triggers*).
Antagonists	**Mort Brack**, **Ned Brack**, **Little Ollie Brack** (CR 2 provisional each, †) + **Sir Pinchington** (giant crab, CR 1/8)
Party	**4 PCs at L6** — Naan, Nalith, Kto, Yinu.
XP	450 × 3 + 25 = 1,375 × **2** (four creatures) = **2,750** → **Medium.**
Duration	2–3 rounds. They give up fast.
Goal (PCs)	Get the walkers past — by any means.
Goal (Bracks)	Collect "one book or bundle of papers" from everyone coming from the lighthouse, and keep the fancy gent's purse.
Skip condition	**Pay the toll** (5 cp "hero discount," or *any* book), or **talk / trick / scare** them (Persuasion, Deception, or Intimidation DC 12; a good joke counts).
Non-lethal	The Bracks fight with sticks, slings, and hugs. Any of their hits that would drop a PC leaves the PC at **1 HP and prone** instead. A Brother reduced to 0 HP is **knocked out**, not killed.

Round Strip & Initiative

Round: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 ☐6

NPC initiative is pre-rolled (`round(avg(1d20 + DEX))`). PCs roll live and write into the blank rows.

Init	Combatant	AC	HP	Notes
__	_____	__	_____	_____
__	_____	__	_____	_____
14	Ned Brack	14	**40** 	☐
13	Mort Brack	13	**45** 	☐
13	Sir Pinchington	15	**13** 	Threatened → all surrender
__	_____	__	_____	_____
__	_____	__	_____	_____
10	Little Ollie Brack	12	**60** 	**Grappling** ☐

Conditions: Bln · Chr · Deaf · Frt · Grp · Inc · Inv · Prl · Pet · Pzn · Prn · Rst · Stn · Uns · Conc

Triggers & Countdowns

- **Everyone surrenders** the moment **any one** of these happens: a Brother drops to 0 HP; two Brothers are Bloodied; **Sir Pinchington is attacked or Bloodied** (Ollie drops everything to protect him). They throw down their sticks: *"We give up! We GIVE UP! Mort, tell them we give up!"*
- **The gate pole.** Mort (or anyone next to the hut) can drop the striped pole as a bonus action: one creature on the road beside the hut makes a **DC 12 Dex save** or falls prone.
- **Salt barrels.** Anyone next to the barrel stack can tip one as an action: a 15-ft line of rolling barrel, **DC 12 Dex save** or prone.
- **The rope swing.** A creature next to the mast can swing up to 20 ft as part of its move without provoking opportunity attacks (**Acrobatics DC 10**, or land prone at the end — the table will love it either way).
- **The hut.** Full cover inside. Any single hit of 10+ bludgeoning or force damage on the hut knocks a wall flat, and whoever is inside is now standing in the open looking embarrassed.
- **After the surrender**, they blab: *"A fancy gent hired us in the night. Golden bird pin on his coat. Big feathery hat."* They hand over the purse he paid them as an apology (see *Loot*).

Tactics Summary

- **Mort Brack** — R1: steps out of the hut and reads **The Fine Print** at the whole party. R2: whacks the nearest PC with his toll stick, shouting regulations. Surrenders first, loudly, on behalf of everyone.
- **Ned Brack** — Hides under the upturned rowboat and slings stones at whoever looks scariest. Uses his one **bucket** on the first PC to come at him.

- **Little Ollie Brack** — Steps out from behind the barrels (badly hidden) and **Big Hugs** the nearest PC, apologising. If Sir Pinchington is threatened, he stops fighting and runs to the tub.
- **Sir Pinchington** — Pinches ankles. Retreats to his tub at half HP.

Loot / Aftermath

- **The fancy gent's purse: 25 gp**, handed over if the Bracks surrender or are befriended.
- **The toll bucket:** 3 cp, a button, and a very old biscuit.
- **The "TOAL" sign** — a souvenir. Worth nothing; priceless.
- **What happens to the Bracks:** see File 1, Scene 1.1 *Conditional follow-through*.

Mort Brack

> *Skinny and sly, tall crooked top hat, sash of copper coins, a stick he calls "the Toll Stick," and a very long scroll of made-up rules.*

Medium humanoid (human), Chaotic Neutral (mostly harmless), † homebrew · CR 2 provisional (450 XP)

AC	13 (patched leather)
HP	**45 · Bloodied 22**
Speed	30 ft.
STR / DEX / CON	12 (+1) · 14 (+2) · 12 (+1)
INT / WIS / CHA	10 (+0) · 8 (–1) · 14 (+2)
Skills	Deception +4, Persuasion +4
Senses	Passive Perception 9
Languages	Common

Actions. ***Multiattack.*** Two **Toll Stick** attacks. ***Toll Stick.*** Melee, reach 5 ft., **+4**, **1d6 + 2 bludgeoning**.

Bonus Actions. ***The Fine Print (Recharge 5–6).*** Mort unrolls his absurd scroll of toll rules and reads it aloud. Each creature of his choice within 30 ft. that can hear him makes a **DC 12 Wis save** or its **speed is halved** until the end of its next turn (it is too busy arguing).

Ned Brack

> *Short and worried, holding a dented tin toll bucket and a sling.*

Medium humanoid (human), Neutral, † homebrew · CR 2 provisional (450 XP)

AC	14 (studded leather)
HP	**40 · Bloodied 20**
Speed	30 ft.
STR / DEX / CON	10 (+0) · 16 (+3) · 12 (+1)
INT / WIS / CHA	9 (–1) · 12 (+1) · 9 (–1)
Skills	Stealth +5

Senses	Passive Perception 11
Languages	Common

Actions. ***Multiattack.*** Two **Sling** attacks. ***Sling.*** Ranged 30/120 ft., **+5**, **1d4 + 3 bludgeoning**. ***Bucket Over the Head (once per fight).*** Melee, reach 5 ft., **+5** against a Medium or smaller creature: the target is **blinded** until the end of its next turn, or until it or an ally uses an action to pull the bucket off.

Little Ollie Brack

> *Enormous, gentle, tiny cap. Says "Sorry!" every time he hits someone. Loves his crab.*

Medium humanoid (human), Neutral Good (honestly), † homebrew · CR 2 provisional (450 XP)

AC	12 (thick coat)
HP	**60** · **Bloodied 30**
Speed	30 ft.
STR / DEX / CON	18 (+4) · 8 (–1) · 16 (+3)
INT / WIS / CHA	8 (–1) · 10 (+0) · 10 (+0)
Skills	Athletics +6
Senses	Passive Perception 10
Languages	Common

Traits. ***Gentle Giant.*** If Sir Pinchington is attacked or Bloodied, Ollie stops fighting and runs to him — and the Brothers surrender.

Actions. ***Multiattack.*** Two **Fist** attacks, or one Fist and one **Big Hug**. ***Fist.*** Melee, reach 5 ft., **+6**, **1d8 + 4 bludgeoning**. ***Big Hug.*** Melee, reach 5 ft., **+6**, **1d6 + 4 bludgeoning**, and the target is **grappled** (escape DC 14). He can hug only one creature at a time.

Sir Pinchington (Giant Crab)

> *A big red crab in a tiny hat. Lives in a washtub. Ollie's best friend.*

Medium beast, unaligned · CR 1/8 (25 XP) — *Monster Manual* giant crab.

AC	15 (natural armor)
HP	**13** (3d8) · **Bloodied 6**
Speed	30 ft., swim 30 ft.
STR / DEX / CON	13 (+1) · 15 (+2) · 11 (+0)
INT / WIS / CHA	1 (–5) · 9 (–1) · 3 (–4)
Skills	Stealth +4
Senses	Blindsight 30 ft., Passive Perception 9
Languages	—

Traits. ***Amphibious.*** Breathes air and water.

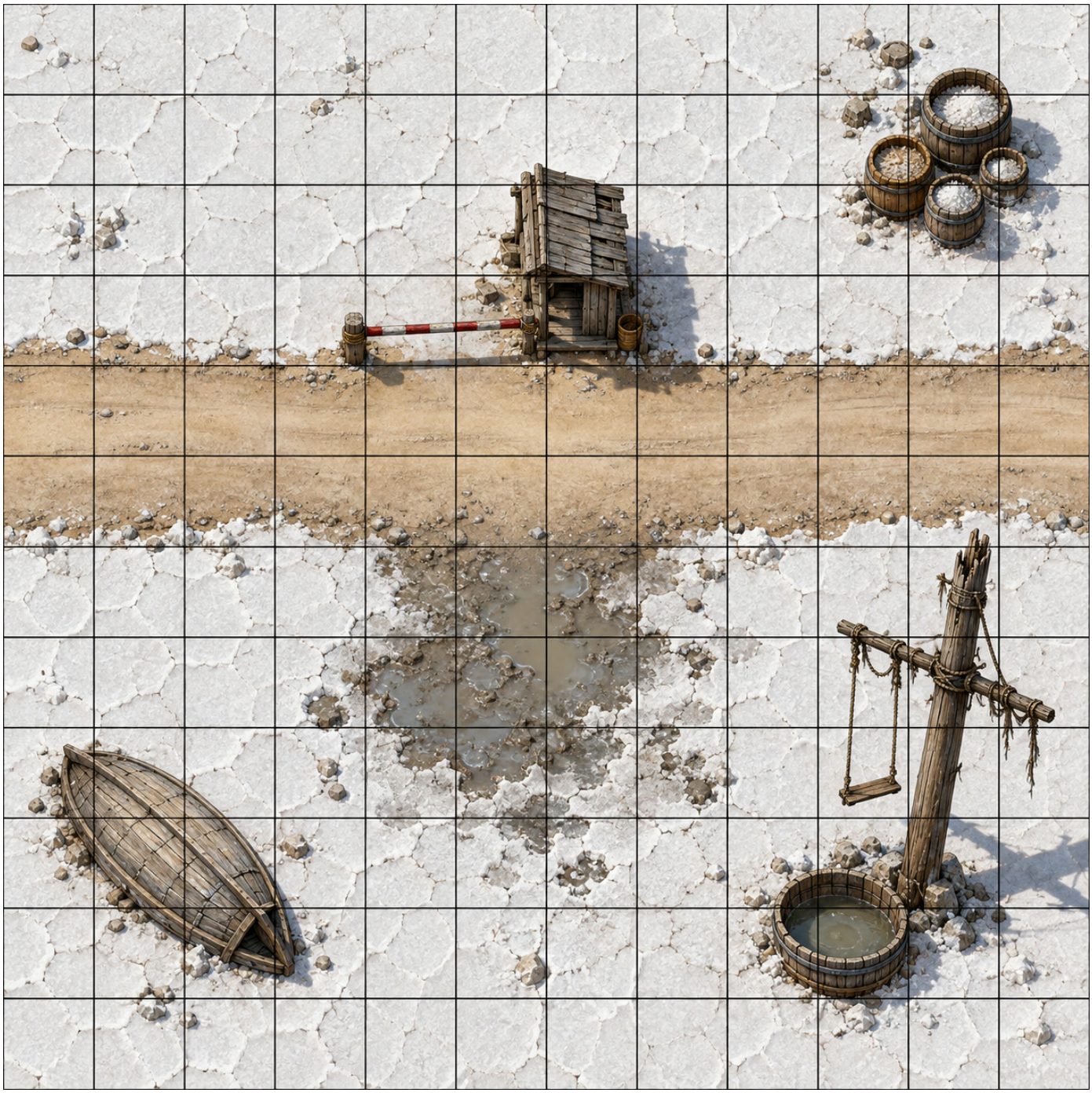
Actions. ***Claw.*** Melee, reach 5 ft., **+3**, **1d6 + 1 bludgeoning**, and the target is **grappled** (escape DC 11). He has two claws, each able to grapple one target.

On 0 HP. Not killed — he pulls into his shell, very offended, and scuttles to his tub.

Encounter 1 — Tactical Layout *(written dimensions remain authoritative)*

Grid: 1 square = 5 ft. Field is 60 ft. × 60 ft. (12 × 12 squares), north up. The party and the walkers come in from the **west edge** on the road; the walkers stop 60 ft. back, off the map.

- **The road** runs west to east across the middle of the field, **15 ft. wide**, from 25 ft. to 40 ft. south of the north edge.
- **The toll hut** — **10 × 10 ft.**, just north of the road at the field's centre. Full cover inside; Mort starts here.
- **The gate pole** lies across the road on the hut's east side.
- **Salt barrels** — a **10 × 10 ft.** stack in the north-east corner area. Half cover. Little Ollie starts behind them (Perception DC 12 to spot).
- **Upturned rowboat** — **10 × 5 ft.**, south-west of the road. Half cover. Ned starts underneath.
- **Broken mast and rope swing** — south-east of the road; the **washtub** (Sir Pinchington's) sits beside it.
- **Wet salt mud** — a **15 × 15 ft.** patch just south of the road, centre field. Difficult terrain.
- **Distances:** west edge → hut **25 ft.**; hut → barrels **20 ft.**; hut → rowboat **30 ft.**; hut → mast **25 ft.**



Encounter 2 — The Grand Sea-Serpent Float

Act III, Scene 3.1 · Hard (2,000 XP × 2 = 4,000 adjusted / Hard 3,600 – Deadly 5,600 at 4×L6)

Summary

Location	**Harbor Way** at sunset — a 30-ft-wide festival street running south to the harbor plaza and its big round fountain. Grandstands, a pickle stall, a puppet show, two confetti cannons.
Light	Bright — sunset plus lanterns everywhere.
Terrain	Cobbles; the **fountain** (20 ft. across, 2 ft. deep: difficult terrain); confetti everywhere (no effect, just joy).
Antagonists	1× **Grand Sea-Serpent Float** (CR 5 provisional, †) + 2× **Clockwork Gull** (CR 1/2 provisional, †)
Bystanders	Three **crowd groups** in the float's path: **A — the grandstand**, **B — the pickle stall**, **C — the puppet show** (little kids). Lord Gullwhistle clinging to the float's back (unless his scroll was lifted in 2.2).
Party	**4 PCs at L6** — Naan, Nalith, Kto, Yinu.
XP	1,800 + 100 × 2 = 2,000 × **2** (three creatures) = **4,000** → **Hard.**
Duration	3–5 rounds.
Goal (PCs)	Stop the float and save the crowd.
Goal (Float)	None — it's a runaway. It rolls at the crowds and chomps whatever hits it.
Three ways to stop it	**(1)** Reduce it to 0 HP. **(2)** ***Dispel Magic*** (see *Triggers*). **(3)** Climb aboard and turn the **brass wind-key** twice.
Non-lethal	It's a parade float with padded jaws. Anyone it drops to 0 HP is **unconscious and stable**, not dying — knocked flat in a pile of confetti.

Round Strip & Initiative

Round: ☐1 ☐2 ☐3 ☐4 ☐5 ☐6 ☐7 ☐8

NPC initiative is pre-rolled (`round(avg(1d20 + DEX))`). PCs roll live and write into the blank rows.

Init	Combatant	AC	HP	Notes
__	_____	__	_____	_____
__	_____	__	_____	_____
13	Clockwork Gull A	13	**22** ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐	
13	Clockwork Gull B	13	**22** ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐ ☐☐	
__	_____	__	_____	_____
__	_____	__	_____	_____

Init	Combatant	AC	HP	Notes
10	Grand Sea-Serpent Float	15	**136 — cross off each 10 lost** ☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐☐	☐☐☐

Crowd groups: A — grandstand [ ] saved [ ] scattered · B — pickle stall [ ] saved [ ] scattered · C — puppet show [ ] saved [ ] scattered

Conditions: Bln · Chr · Deaf · Frt · Grp · Inc · Inv · Prl · Pet · Pzn · Prn · Rst · Stn · Uns · Conc

Triggers & Countdowns

- **Round 1 — Waking Up.** On its first turn the float only creaks, shudders, and sneezes confetti: **it does not move.** Every PC gets a turn to react before it rolls.
- **Runaway.** From round 2, at the start of each of its turns the float rolls up to 30 ft. toward the **nearest crowd group not yet saved or scattered**. **Distracted:** if any creature hit it since its last turn, it rolls toward the creature that hit it most recently instead, and attacks that creature. Hitting it is how you pull it away from the crowd. When no crowd groups are left, it chases whoever hit it last.
- **Crowd groups.** A PC within 10 ft. of a group can use an action to get them clear — shouting, herding, carrying kids, a clever spell. No roll for a sensible plan; DC 10 for a wild one. Mark it **saved**. If the float reaches a group that hasn't been saved, that group **scatters**: stalls flattened, people diving into hay bales and the fountain, nobody hurt — but it isn't saved.
- **Dispel Magic.** The *Scroll of the Rising Tide* † is a **5th-level** effect: ***dispel magic*** cast with a 5th-level slot ends it automatically; with a lower slot, make a spellcasting ability check, **DC 15**. When it ends, the float rolls down into the fountain and stops.
- **The brass wind-key.** A creature next to the float can climb aboard as part of its move (**Athletics or Acrobatics DC 13**, costs 10 ft.; automatic for the first PC to try **if Marisol shouted the secret** in round 1). Aboard, it moves with the float; Chomp can't reach it, but Tail Swipe can — on a hit, the rider is also thrown 10 ft. off the float and lands prone. Turning the key is an action with a **DC 13 Strength (Athletics)** check; **two successes** wind it down and it coasts into the fountain.
- **Lord Gullwhistle.** Clinging to the float's back (9 HP, takes no actions). Any PC aboard can pluck him off and set him down as part of their move. An area spell aimed at the float's back will catch him — he drops **unconscious, not dying**, and lands in the fountain (warn the table first).
- **Area spells near crowds.** Before anyone casts *fireball*, *lightning bolt*, or another area spell, warn the table if the area touches an unsaved crowd group. If they cast anyway, the crowd dives clear comically — but that group counts as **scattered**.
- **Hazards anyone can use:** a **confetti cannon** (action, adjacent PC: 30-ft. line, **DC 13 Con save** or blinded until the end of the target's next turn — works on the float and the gulls); a **fountain water jet** (action, adjacent PC: 30-ft. line, **DC 13 Str save** or pushed 10 ft. and prone — Huge float is only pushed, never knocked prone); **pickle barrels** at stall B (action: 15-ft. line, **DC 12 Dex save** or prone, and everything smells of dill).
- **Allies who may arrive:** the **Brack Brothers** (if befriended in 1.1) clear one crowd group on round 2; **Lady Marisol** (if she switched sides in 2.2) shouts the wind-key secret on round 1.
- **When the float stops:** it ends in the fountain with a long sad whistle and a fountain-sized splash. The gulls drop out of the sky and lie in the confetti, ticking. Go to Scene 3.2.

Tactics Summary

- **Grand Sea-Serpent Float** — R1: wakes up (no move). R2+: Runaway toward the nearest unsaved crowd, Chomp whatever is in front of it, Tail Swipe anyone behind or beside it. Uses **Confetti Breath** whenever it recharges and three or more creatures are in the cone.
- **Clockwork Gulls** — Dive-bomb the PC who is doing the most damage to the float. Snatch hats and snacks between attacks. Fly out of reach.

Loot / Aftermath

- **The float's wreck**: brass gears, painted canvas, and one goofy wooden head that the festival keeps as a trophy forever.
- **Rewards** come in Scene 3.2 (restitution, the crowd's cheers, Heroic Inspiration if all three groups were saved) — see File 1 *Loot & Rewards Summary*.

Grand Sea-Serpent Float

> *A house-sized clockwork sea serpent of painted wood, canvas, and brass gears, teal-and-gold scales, a goofy grinning face, padded wooden jaws, a big brass wind-key on its back, and squeaky wheels.*

Huge construct, unaligned, † homebrew · CR 5 provisional (1,800 XP)

AC	15 (painted planks)
HP	**136** (13d12 + 52) · **Bloodied 68**
Speed	30 ft. (wheels; it cannot climb)
STR / DEX / CON	20 (+5) · 8 (–1) · 18 (+4)
INT / WIS / CHA	3 (–4) · 10 (+0) · 1 (–5)
Damage Immunities	Poison, psychic
Condition Immunities	Charmed, exhaustion, frightened, paralyzed, petrified, poisoned
Senses	Darkvision 60 ft. (painted glass eyes), Passive Perception 10
Languages	—

Traits. ***Animated by the Scroll.*** A 5th-level magical effect; see *Dispel Magic* in Triggers. ***Runaway / Distracted / Waking Up.*** See Triggers. ***Brass Wind-Key.*** Two successful DC 13 Strength (Athletics) actions by a creature aboard stop it.

Actions. ***Multiattack.*** One **Chomp** and one **Tail Swipe**. ***Chomp.*** Melee, reach 10 ft., **+7**, **3d8 + 5 bludgeoning**. ***Tail Swipe.*** Melee, reach 15 ft., **+7**, **2d8 + 5 bludgeoning**, and the target makes a **DC 15 Str save** or falls prone. ***Confetti Breath (Recharge 5–6).*** Replaces Multiattack. A 30-ft. cone of confetti: each creature in it makes a **DC 14 Con save** or is **blinded** until the end of its next turn.

On 0 HP. It collapses into the fountain in a heap of canvas, springs, and one sad whistle.

Clockwork Gull

> *A brass seagull the size of a cat, the Gull Club's mascot, flapping on wind-up wings. Steals hats.*

Small construct, unaligned, † homebrew · CR 1/2 provisional (100 XP)

AC	13
HP	**22** (5d6 + 5) · **Bloodied 11**
Speed	10 ft., fly 50 ft.
STR / DEX / CON	8 (–1) · 14 (+2) · 12 (+1)
INT / WIS / CHA	3 (–4) · 10 (+0) · 5 (–3)
Damage Immunities	Poison
Condition Immunities	Poisoned
Senses	Passive Perception 10
Languages	—

Traits. ***Flyby.*** Doesn't provoke opportunity attacks when it flies out of an enemy's reach. ***Dive-Bomb.*** If it flies at least 20 ft. straight toward a target and then hits it with Peck, the target makes a **DC 12 Str save** or falls prone.

Actions. ***Peck.*** Melee, reach 5 ft., **+4**, **1d6 + 2 piercing**.

Bonus Actions. ***Snatch.*** Grabs a hat, snack, or other small non-magical item that isn't a weapon or spellcasting focus from a creature within 5 ft. Purely for laughs.

On 0 HP. Drops out of the air and lies on the cobbles, ticking.

Encounter 2 — Tactical Layout *(written dimensions remain authoritative)*

Grid: 1 square = 5 ft. Field is 80 ft. × 80 ft. (16 × 16 squares), north up. The float starts at the north edge; the party is at the front of the parade, about **30 ft. south of the float**, in the middle of the street.

- **Harbor Way** — a **30-ft.-wide** cobbled street running north to south down the middle of the field.
- **The float** starts at the **north edge, centred on the street** (Huge, 15 × 15 ft.).
- **Crowd A — the grandstand** — wooden bleachers **15 × 30 ft.** on the street's **west** side, starting 15 ft. from the north edge.
- **Crowd B — the pickle stall** — a stall and a parked cart, **15 × 15 ft.**, on the street's **east** side, starting 25 ft. from the north edge. Dagna's barrels are here.
- **Crowd C — the puppet show** — a striped booth, **10 × 10 ft.**, **south-west**, beside the fountain.
- **The harbor plaza** fills the **southern 20 ft.** of the field; the **fountain** is **20 ft. across**, centred in the plaza.
- **Confetti cannons** — one at each **north corner** of the street.
- **Distances:** float → party **30 ft.**; float → grandstand **~15 ft.**; float → pickle stall **~25 ft.**; float → puppet show **~45 ft.**; float → fountain **~45 ft.**



Player Handouts — The Tide Festival

Session 008 · Show each picture at the table when the party meets that person or place — not all at once, and not before.

> ***Portrait pages are image and name only.*** *Each portrait page holds one picture scaled to fill the sheet and the name in large bold type at the foot of the page, added by the PDF renderer. The artwork has no lettering of its own. Read the cues from File 1 aloud.*

Where We Left Off



Last session (007): Oberon's portal dropped you at night on the dried-up bed of the Sea of Fallen Stars, where a lighthouse with no sea to warn swept its beam over you, and each of you saw the thing you wanted most — and believed it was waiting inside the tower. At the stranded ship *Embergull*, the camp keeper Oren fed you soup and warned you that the light eats people. **Yinu** tried to fly to the tower and **vanished in the beam** — and woke up **chained in the lantern room** with four other prisoners, then Misty Stepped free. At the door, **Nalith** broke the keeper **Tamsin Reed**'s spell with *dispel magic*, and Tamsin led you to the top.

In the lantern room, a woman named **Veyra** was calling up a **Brine Fiend** to eat the prisoners. **Kto**'s arrows, **Naan**'s *cloud of daggers*, and Yinu's shadowspawn wore them down, and **Yinu's lightning bolt** finished Veyra — the demon fell apart into a puddle of salt water. Tamsin turned her key and **the light went out**. You freed the four prisoners and found Veyra's **ledger**: a list of people in the city of **New Sarshel** who paid her for her work.

Today: the sun is coming up, the lighthouse is dark behind you, and about fifteen grateful people are walking with you nine miles east to New Sarshel.

New Sarshel at the Tide Festival



- A harbor city of pale stone towers and red roofs that **chased the sea**: when the water drew back, New Sarshel built new docks to follow it, and grew rich.
- Every balcony has a paper lantern. Every street has bunting. Somebody is always playing a fiddle.
- It is the **Tide Festival**, and everyone already seems to know who you are.



Tamsin Reed



The Brack Brothers



Lord Percival Gullwhistle



Tibbet Sparkwright

The Grand Sea-Serpent Float



- A house-sized clockwork sea serpent of painted wood and brass gears, teal and gold, with a goofy grin — and it's moving.
- Confetti everywhere. Squeaky wheels. Somebody shouting "RISE, O SEA!"

Handout — The Tide Festival Schedule

(Warden Plumm hands this out at the gate in Scene 1.2.)

THE TIDE FESTIVAL OF NEW SARSHEL — *the city that caught the sea!*

Lantern Eve

All day — stalls open on Festival Green

Dusk — **Harbor Lanterns**: float a lantern for someone you miss or something you hope for

Tide Day

Noon — **The Noon Bells** and the Blessing of the Tide at the Hall of Many Lights

Afternoon — **Festival Games** on Festival Green: the Archery Contest · the Crab Races · the Pickle-Eating Contest (*no pickled eggs this year, by request*)

Sunset — **The Grand Parade** down Harbor Way to the fountain, featuring the Gilded Gull Club's famous Sea-Serpent Float

Nightfall — **Fireworks** over the harbor by Tibbet Sparkwright

Heroes of the lighthouse ride at the front of the parade, free!

Handout — Veyra's Ledger

(The party already has this. Read or show it whenever they look at it.)

A small leather book in a neat hand. Most pages are notes in a fiery script you can't read. One page is a list:

- **Lord Percival Gullwhistle** — 400 gp — *for the Summoning*
- **Lady Marisol Brightwater** — 400 gp — *for the Summoning*
- **Sir Dunstan Pellow** — 400 gp — *for the Summoning*

Under the list, underlined twice: *"G.G.C. — pay on the full moon."*

DM Quick Reference — The Tide Festival

Party and continuity

- **4 PCs at Level 6:** Naan (Lilli), Nalith (Piper), Kto (Kaitlyn), Yinu (Sev). Not playing: Fiorn (Fox — own game), Dirk (Ari), Tyvlex (Kaila).
- **Thresholds (4×L6):** Easy 1,200 · Medium 2,400 · Hard 3,600 · Deadly 5,600.
- **Starts:** straight after Session 007 — dawn on the salt road, lighthouse dark, ledger in hand, ~15 walkers.
- **Rest:** short rest on the road (breakfast); **long rest Lantern Eve night** at the Salty Pelican.
- **Tone:** silly villains who give up, slapstick hazards, nobody dies, every PC gets a win.

Act / Scene Flow

ID	Scene	Encounter	Key cues	Leads to
1.1	The Salt Road Parade	**Enc. 1** (optional, Medium)	Walkers' personalities; "TOAL" booth; pay / trick / fight; Bracks blab **"golden bird pin, big feathery hat"**	1.2
1.2	Heroes at the Gate	None	Wren ran ahead → crowd cheers; Warden Plumm; free beds; schedule handout; Lantern Eve lanterns (Nalith); long rest	2.1
2.1	Bells and Blessings	None	Noon Bells; mass for the PC who missed it (most likely Naan); Kto's name read out; Amsel reads ledger → **Gilded Gull Club, Gull Row, "for the Summoning"**	2.2
2.2	Festival Games and the Gilded Gulls	None	Archery (Kto) · crabs (Nalith) · fireworks (Yinu) · pickles (all); find the Gulls; Marisol confesses; Tibbet: "tonight I read the Tide Scroll"	3.1
3.1	The Runaway Float	**Enc. 2** (Hard)	"RISE, O SEA!"; save 3 crowd groups; stop it 3 ways	3.2
3.2	Fireworks and Rewards	None	Fountain confession; restitution; Heroes of the Tide; Tamsin keeps the harbor light; Captain Lorrow's offer	Session 009

The secret (DM only)

- The **Gilded Gull Club** (Gullwhistle, Brightwater, Pellow) paid Veyra **400 gp each** to "summon the tide" back to **Gull Row**, now a mile inland. They knew nothing about prisoners or demons.
- Gullwhistle saw the light go out, panicked, hired the **Bracks**, and carries Veyra's ***Scroll of the Rising Tide*** (really an animate-objects scroll).

Conditions that carry forward

- **Bracks befriended / paid / let go (1.1)** → they clear one crowd group on round 2 of Enc. 2.
- **Bracks beaten (1.1)** → handed to the watch at the gate; in the stocks on Festival Green in 2.2, selling souvenirs, repeating the pin clue.
- **Ledger shown to Plumm (1.2)** → in 2.2 she points out the three Gulls by name.
- **Club exposed (2.2)** → Gullwhistle reads the scroll to save face; 3.2 adds the free feast and his hat. **Not exposed** → he reads it as the parade finale. **3.1 happens either way.**
- **Marisol switched sides (2.2)** → she shouts the wind-key secret on round 1; first climb aboard is automatic.
- **Scroll lifted (2.2)** → he reads a second copy from the grandstand; nobody is riding the float.
- **Crowd groups saved (3.1)** → bigger cheers; **all three saved = Heroic Inspiration for every PC**.

Encounter 1 — Brack Brothers (Act I, Scene 1.1)

- **Mort** AC 13, HP 45 · **Ned** AC 14, HP 40 · **Ollie** AC 12, HP 60 · **Sir Pinchington** AC 15, HP 13.
- **Skip:** pay 5 cp or any book; DC 12 Persuasion / Deception / Intimidation; a good joke.
- **Surrender:** a Brother at 0 HP, two Bloodied, or **the crab threatened**.
- **Props:** gate pole (DC 12 Dex), salt barrels (DC 12 Dex), rope swing (Acrobatics DC 10), flimsy hut.
- **Non-lethal:** PCs drop to 1 HP and prone instead of 0.

Encounter 2 — The Float (Act III, Scene 3.1)

- **Float** AC 15, HP 136, speed 30 · Chomp +7 (3d8+5) · Tail +7 reach 15 (2d8+5, DC 15 Str or prone) · Confetti Breath (DC 14 Con or blinded).
- **Gulls ×2** AC 13, HP 22, fly 50 · Peck +4 (1d6+2) · Dive-Bomb (DC 12 Str or prone).
- **Round 1:** float wakes up, doesn't move.
- **Runaway:** rolls at the nearest unsaved crowd; **hit it and it chases you instead.**
- **Save a crowd:** action within 10 ft., no roll for a sensible plan.
- **Stop it:** 0 HP · *dispel magic* (5th-level effect; DC 15 check below 5th) · wind-key: climb DC 13, then two DC 13 Athletics actions.
- **Gullwhistle** aboard (9 HP); area spells catch him — warn first. Anyone dropped is unconscious and stable, not dying.

NPC cues

NPC	Voice / look	Wants	Gives
Wren Ashby	Breathless, autograph book	To meet heroes	Runs ahead → heroes' welcome
Hettie Quillfeather	Halfling, ink-stained, map	Show off her map	Gull Row is a mile inland — the "why"
Dagna Stoutbarrel	Dwarf, pickle wagon	Win the pickle contest	Pickle contest; barrels in Enc. 2
Bram Tolliver	Old singer	Sing	A shanty at every "sea"
Warden Plumm	Halfling, clipboard, whistle	A perfect festival	Beds, schedule, restitution, titles
Brother Amsel	Round, kind, nosy	Welcome everyone	Mass; reads the ledger; letter home
Gullwhistle	Loud laugh, sweating	Sea back; no embarrassment	Tries to buy the ledger; reads the scroll
Marisol Brightwater	Polite, sad	Swim off her pier	Confession; wind-key secret
Dunstan Pellow	Bluster, cane	Never admit a mistake	"It was Percival's idea!"
Tibbet Sparkwright	Old gnome, singed, sparkler	Perfect finale	Scroll clue; *Pyrotechnics* scroll
Tamsin Reed	Tired, warm	Something to keep	Yinu's staff; new keeper of the harbor light
Captain Ama Lorrow	Half-orc, grin	Good company	Free passage → Session 009

Rewards

- 25 gp (Bracks) · 600 gp (Gull Club) · 2 potions of healing (Hall) · 3 +1 arrows and sash (archery) · Admiral Snips (crabs) · scroll of *Pyrotechnics* (Tibbet) · Golden Gherkin (pickles) · Gullwhistle's hat (if exposed early) · Heroic Inspiration (all crowds saved) · free passage (*Laughing Otter*).

Leave open

- Veyra's real backers and purpose · Sela, Oberon · drow under Old Skull · Yinu's cipher book · Naan's Lathander letter · where Fiorn is.

Post-play notes

- Where does the party want the *Laughing Otter* to take them? → Session 009.
- Who won which game? Who kept the ledger?